



Palm Island
COMMUNITY COMPANY

ANNUAL REPORT

2024 - 2025

Palm Island Community Company

Community controlled since 1994 | ABN/ACN 640 793 728

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF COUNTRY

We honour this land



The Palm Island Community Company acknowledges the Traditional Owners of Palm Island, the Manbarra people. We also acknowledge the many First Nations persons who were forcibly removed to Palm Island, and we recognise these persons and their descendants as the historical Bwgcolman people. We recognise the continued connection of the Manbarra and Bwgcolman peoples to the land and waters of this beautiful island. We pay respect to Manbarra and Bwgcolman Elders, their ancestors, all First Nations peoples, and our ancestors who walk in the Dreamtime.

FROM OUR LEADERS

Messages from the CEO & Chair

R

Rachel Atkinson

Chief Executive Officer

This year has been one of tremendous growth for our organisation. With 210 staff members and \$23.4 million in revenue, PICC continues to be the largest employer on Palm Island and the most significant provider of community services. Our commitment to community control and self-determination remains at the heart of everything we do.

We have achieved a major milestone with the implementation of Delegated Authority under the Child Protection Act, meaning our community now decides care arrangements for our children. This has been a decades-long goal. We also launched the First 1,000 Days program, expanded our Bwgcolman Healing Service, and continued to grow our Digital Service Centre partnership with Telstra.

L

Luella Bligh

Chair

On behalf of the Board of Directors, I am proud to present the 2024-2025 Annual Report of the Palm Island Community Company. This year we have seen continued growth in service delivery and community impact. The Board remains committed to strong governance and ensuring PICC operates in the best interests of Palm Islanders.

Our financial position remains sound with total revenue of \$23.4 million. We passed the Human Services Quality Framework audit with flying colours, maintaining our commitment to excellence in service delivery. I thank our dedicated staff, management team, and fellow Board members for their tireless work serving our community.

YEAR IN NUMBERS

2024-2025 at a Glance

A snapshot of our impact across Palm Island this financial year.



210

Staff members employed

\$23.4M

Total revenue

16

Community services delivered

80%

Staff identifying as Aboriginal &/or Torres Strait Islander

31

Years community controlled

70%

Staff living on Palm Island

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

Making a Difference

Our biggest achievements and milestones from the past year.

Staff Growth to 197 Employees

Staff increased 30% to 197 employees, with over 70% being Palm Islanders

197 staff, 70%+ Palm Islanders

Delegated Authority Implementation

Community now decides care arrangements for children - a decades-long goal achieved under the Child Protection Act

Full community control over child protection decisions

First 1,000 Days Program Launch

New maternal and child health program ensuring Indigenous families get timely care during the crucial first 1,000 days

New program serving families from pregnancy to age 2

Health Services Expansion

Bwgcolman Healing Service delivered comprehensive healthcare to 2,283 clients with 17,488 episodes of care

2,283 clients, 17,488 episodes of care

Safe Haven Children Support

Supported 1,187 children through the Safe Haven service, providing safe spaces and support

1,187 children supported

RACGP Accreditation Renewed

Renewed RACGP Quality Practice Accreditation, valid until 2027

Accreditation renewed to 2027

Digital Service Centre Growth

Telstra Digital Service Centre supporting 50 languages with 21 staff members

50 languages supported, 21 staff

Revenue of \$23.4 Million

Revenue of \$23.4 million supporting 16 services across health, family support, justice, disability, and economic development

\$23.4M revenue, 16 services delivered

CORPORATE GOVERNANCE

Our Board & Leadership



Governance Highlights

- PICC continues to have an average of over 80 per cent of its staff members identifying as Aboriginal, Torres Strait Islander or both.
- The proportion of staff members living on Palm Island is still above 70 per cent.
- PICC passed the Human Services Quality Framework audit with flying colours.

Board of Directors

Emmakita Geia

PI Community Nominee

Georgina Haines

PI Community Nominee

Jim Petrich

Independent Chair

Magdalena Blackley

Director (PIASC nominee)

Mark Johnston

Director (Qld Govt nominee)

Mislam Sam

Director (PI Community nominee)

Paul Travis

Director (PIASC nominee)

Yolanda Coutts

Alternate Director

Zacchais Sam

PI Community Nominee

Luella Bligh

Chair

Rhonda Phillips

Director

Allan Palm Island

Director

Harriet Hulthen

Director

Raymond W. Palmer Snr

Director

Cassie Lang

Director

Management Team

Ian Jessup

Company Secretary

Mark McCann

Company Secretary

Michael Gilmour

Company Secretary

Rachel Atkinson

General Manager

Matthew Lindsay

Company Secretary

OUR SERVICES

16 Services for Our Community

Delivering health, family support, justice, crisis, youth, and disability services across Palm Island.



● Health & Healing

Bwgcolman Healing Service

Social and Emotional Wellbeing Service

Women's Healing Service

● Justice & Diversionary

Community Justice Group

Diversionary Service

● Community

Digital Service Centre

● Family & Children

Early Childhood Services (CFC)

Family Care Service

Family Participation Program

Family Wellbeing Centre

Women's Service

● Disability

NDIS Service

● Crisis & Safety

Safe Haven

Safe House

Specialist Domestic and Family Violence Service

● Youth

Youth Service

STAFF REPORT CARD

Our People

PICC is the largest employer on Palm Island, with a workforce that reflects our community.

Staff Numbers (3-Year Trend)



80%

Aboriginal &/or Torres Strait Islander staff

70%

Staff living on Palm Island

+39%

Staff growth over 3 years



INNOVATION ON COUNTRY

Building Our Future, Our Way

Community-led projects driving self-determination through innovation, culture, and technology.

Palm Island Photo Studio

IN PROGRESS

A professional photography studio on Palm Island enabling community members to document their stories, culture, and achievements without leaving Country. Provid...

The Station

PLANNING

A multi-purpose community facility serving as a gathering space, cultural center, and service delivery point. The Station brings services to the community in a ...

On-Country Server

IN PROGRESS

Local server infrastructure hosted on Palm Island, ensuring data sovereignty and reducing dependence on external cloud services. Stores stories, media, and comm...

Annual Report System

PLANNING

System to generate annual impact reports directly from community stories and data, eliminating need for external consultants. Saves \$40k-115k annually while mai...

Elders Cultural Trips

COMPLETED

Regular trips taking elders back to traditional sites and Country. Combines cultural preservation, intergenerational knowledge transfer, and elder wellbeing. St...

"When we tell our own stories with our own technology, we keep our culture strong for the next generation."

— Community Elder, Palm Island

FINANCIAL SUMMARY

*Financial Report 2024-2025***Balance Sheet**

	2024-25	2023-24
Current Assets	\$8,500,000	\$8,156,480
Non Current Assets	\$2,400,000	\$2,702,284
TOTAL Assets	\$10,900,000	\$10,858,764
Current Liabilities	\$6,300,000	\$5,969,264
Non Current Liabilities	\$1,100,000	\$1,351,259
TOTAL Liabilities	\$7,400,000	\$7,320,523
NET ASSETS	\$3,500,000	\$3,538,241

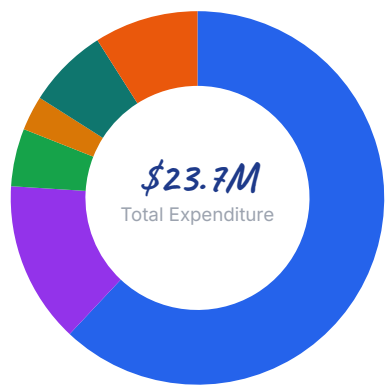
Income & Expenditure Statement

	2024-25	2023-24
INCOME	\$23,400,000	\$23,400,335
Total Labour Costs	\$14,700,000	\$14,282,962
Administration Expenses	\$3,300,000	\$3,300,000
Property & Energy Expenses	\$1,200,000	\$1,200,000
Motor Vehicle Expenses	\$700,000	\$700,000
Travel & Training Expenses	\$1,600,000	\$1,600,000
Client Related Costs	\$2,200,000	\$2,200,000
Total Expenditure	\$23,700,000	\$23,282,962
NET SURPLUS (DEFICIT)	(\$300,000)	\$117,373

*These figures are from the audited financial statements.

WHERE THE MONEY GOES

Expenditure Breakdown



	Total Labour Costs	62%
	\$14.7M	
	Administration Expenses	14%
	\$3.3M	
	Property & Energy Expenses	5%
	\$1.2M	
	Motor Vehicle Expenses	3%
	\$711K	
	Travel & Training Expenses	7%
	\$1.7M	
	Client Related Costs	9%
	\$2.1M	

Total Income	Total Expenditure	Net Result
\$23.4M	\$23.7M	\$-300K

OUR PARTNERS

Working Together

PICC works with 23 partners across government, health, education, and community sectors.

● Government Partners

- Queensland Government Department of Child Safety
- Queensland Health
- Commonwealth Department of Health and Aged Care
- National Indigenous Australians Agency (NIAA)
- Department of Social Services
- National Disability Insurance Agency (NDIA)
- Palm Island Aboriginal Shire Council

● Corporate Partners

- Telstra

● Health Partners

- Townsville University Hospital
- Mater Hospital
- Royal Flying Doctor Service
- CheckUP Queensland
- North Queensland Primary Health Network
- Fred Hollows Foundation

● Education Partners

- James Cook University
- TAFE Queensland
- Bwgcolman Community School

● Peak Bodies

- SNAICC
- QATSICPP

● Community Partners

- Act for Kids
- Relationships Australia
- Anglicare
- Lives Lived Well



"The Palm Island Community Company is deeply committed to the principles of community control and self-determination. We uphold the spirit of community control by consistently adhering to these principles, ensuring that our actions reflect our dedication to empowering Palm Islanders."

Palm Island Community Company

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